

Flower Dedication

The flowers adorning the sanctuary this morning are given in loving memory of Merrell McQueen. — *With love, Susan & Bob Joiner*

Announcements

**Roca Blanca Project Fund.** *One week left — the team leaves Saturday, September 26.* We are so thankful for the gifts that have been given for this project! With that said, we lack about \$3,500 to reach our goal of \$9,500, which will go toward medical clinic outreach, children’s ministry outreach, a painting project at the base, and 40 food packs to deliver to needy families. Give conveniently online at [fpccorinth.org](http://fpccorinth.org) — choose “GIVE online” and select “Roca Blanca Mission Trip” in the drop-down menu — or pick up an envelope at the church to drop off a donation. Thank you for participating in the work of the Lord at home and in other countries!

**Samaritan’s Purse Shoeboxes.** Collection boxes are available in the children’s wing and the side entrance by the church office. You can participate by shopping and collecting items, or by donating monetarily — each shoebox costs \$10 to ship. Items needed: small composition notebooks, pencils, small cars/trucks, puzzles, jump ropes, hair bows/barrettes/brushes/combs, underwear in larger sizes, and small stuffed animals. No liquids, candy, or food!

Those Who Serve Today

- Assisting Elder** — Cole Sanders

**Greeters** — John & Claire Windsor

**Acolytes** — Brandon Giaccagliini & Will Sanders

**Circle of Prayer** — Becky Stewart & Jack Griffith

**AV Engineer** — Russell Smith
- Ushers** — Dave Shanklin, Peter Fisher, Cameron Crockett, JR Burns, & Nick Ashmore

**Nursery** — Deborah Kiddy, Courtney Monaghan, Laurin Porter, Maribel Albarran, & Kyle & Meghan Holcombe

Church Staff

- Rev. Waring Porter** - Pastor

**Gregg Parker** - Dir. of Discipleship

**Bobby Capps** - Dir. of Outreach & Care

**Jennifer Shipp** - Dir. of Student Ministries

**Laura Kate Carmichiel** - Dir. of Women’s Min. & Comm.
- Phyllis Sellers** - Day School Director

**Jan Pike** - Choir Director

**Malechi Doren** - Accompanist

**Teresa Tsagarakis** - Administrative Assistant

**Sammy Allred** - Bookkeeper

The Church Calendar

- September 22** Women’s Bible Study — Youth House, 8 a.m.

**September 23** KidsQuest · Youth · Women’s Bible Study, 6 p.m.

**September 24** MI3 Week 7
- Sept. 26 – Oct. 3** Roca Blanca Mission Trip

**Sept. 29 – Oct. 2** LeConte Pilgrimage

**October 7** Outdoor Movie Night: *Mary Poppins*, 6:30 p.m.

Online Giving



Scan to give online



FIRST PRESBYTERIAN CHURCH

September 20, 2026

Seventeenth Sunday after Pentecost

*“To be disciples, to make disciples”*

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# Welcome

## We Are Glad You Are Here!

We are honored that you decided to join us this morning. Whether it is your first time in church, your first time in a long while, or part of your regular rhythm, we hope you will be encouraged by the fellowship with each other, and with our Lord, as we worship him together.

If this is your first time with us, please take a moment and fill out a Next Steps Card found on the back of the pew. We would love to meet you and help you get connected.

## Children & Nursery

Children (age 4+) and their families worship together in the sanctuary, where children will be dismissed to Children’s Church during the service. Children’s bulletins and crayons are available at both entrances to the Sanctuary. Children are always welcome in worship!

Nursery rooms for infants through age 3 are in the Education Wing, with the entrance behind the playground on the west side of campus. If you have a newborn and/or are nursing your baby, please feel free to use our baby room just off the narthex — a quiet space with comfortable seating where the worship service is broadcast as well.

## Our Vision & Mission

Our vision is to see lives transformed by the power of the gospel, rooted in God’s Word and the Reformed tradition, in order to create a culture of discipleship at FPC where disciples WORSHIP holistically, GROW relationally in Christ, and SERVE boldly in the world for the glory of God. Our mission is to accomplish this by “Being Disciples and Making Disciples.”

## Connect With Us

**Website:** [fpccorinth.org](http://fpccorinth.org)  
**Phone:** 662-286-6638  
**Address:** 919 East Shiloh Rd, Corinth, MS 38834

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# Sermon Outline

## “Restored by Grace: Living as God’s Holy People”

Rev. Waring Porter · Ezra 9:1–4

When we think about sin in our life, we should understand that one of the most dangerous things about sin is not simply that we commit it; it is that we can gradually become comfortable with it. This is because a danger does not become less dangerous simply because we have become accustomed to it. That is the uncomfortable message we encounter in Ezra 9. When Ezra arrives in Jerusalem, he discovers something deeply troubling: God’s people have begun compromising with the very nations and practices from which God had called them to remain distinct. God’s people were becoming comfortable with sin.

We are saved and restored by grace, and grace means God has rescued us in order that we might belong to Him and live for Him. Being restored by grace does not make the pursuit of holiness optional. In fact, grace restores God’s people so that they might once again live as God’s holy people. Let’s consider what it means to live as God’s holy people.

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### I. The Seriousness of Sin (vv. 1–2)

*Deuteronomy 7:3–4 — “You shall not intermarry with them, giving your daughters to their sons or taking their daughters for your sons, for they would turn away your sons from following me, to serve other gods.”*

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### II. Called to Covenant Holiness (v. 2)

*Deuteronomy 7:6 — “For you are a people holy to the Lord your God.”*  
*1 Corinthians 6:19–20 — “You are not your own, for you were bought with a price.”*

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### III. The Response of God’s Holy People (vv. 3–4)

*Psalms 51:4 — “Against you, you only, have I sinned and done what is evil in your sight, so that you may be justified in your words and blameless in your judgment.”*

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*Resources: Matthew Henry’s Commentary, Vol. 2, Matthew Henry; Ezra & Nehemiah, Derek Kidner; Ezra & Nehemiah, Jacob M. Myers; Westminster Confession of Faith*

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**THE LORD’S SUPPER**  
The Lord’s Supper is a means of grace in which Christ spiritually nourishes believers, strengthening their faith as they partake of the bread and cup in union with Him. We reflect on how thankful we are for the work of Christ on our behalf, and we pray that his grace would work more powerfully in our lives to change us more into his likeness. The sacrament is a tangible, concrete gift where we can physically remember the goodness of the gospel story.

**The Sacrament of the Lord’s Supper**

Invitation to the Table

**Profession of Faith:** The Apostles’ Creed

*I believe in God, the Father almighty, Maker of heaven and earth, and in Jesus Christ, his only Son, our Lord, who was conceived by the Holy Ghost, born of the Virgin Mary, suffered under Pontius Pilate, was crucified, dead and buried; he descended into hell; the third day he rose again from the dead; he ascended into heaven, and sitteth on the right hand of God the Father Almighty; from thence he shall come to judge the quick and the dead. I believe in the Holy Ghost, the holy catholic\* Church, the communion of saints, the forgiveness of sins, the resurrection of the body, and the life everlasting. Amen.*

*\*that is, the true Christian church of all times and all places*

**The Words of Institution:** 1 Corinthians 11:23–29

Partaking of the Elements

Prayer of Thanksgiving

**SENDING**

**BENEDICTION**  
God’s people are blessed by the Lord and sent forth into the world, bearing with them the hope and peace of the Gospel. As we continue our worship, we do so as people sent to our community for reconciliation, bearing witness to the good news of the gospel.

**\*Benediction**

**\*Postlude**

**\*Hymn of Commitment: #206**

*“There Is a Redeemer”*

***LITURGY FOR THE WORSHIP OF GOD***

September 20, 2026

*\* Indicates congregation standing if able*

*Our worship is a covenant conversation between God and His people. Throughout the service, God graciously speaks to us through His Word, and we joyfully respond with praise, confession, prayer, faith, thanksgiving, and obedience.*

**GATHERING**

**The Piano Prelude**

**Greetings & Announcements**

**Preparation for Worship:** Matthew 11:28–29

“Come to me, all who labor and are heavy laden, and I will give you rest. Take my yoke upon you, and learn from me, for I am gentle and lowly in heart, and you will find rest for your souls.”

**The Prelude**

**Choral Introit**

*“Glorify Thy Name”*

**\*Scriptural Call to Worship:** based on Isaiah 6:1–3 & Psalm 95:6–7

Leader: In the year that King Uzziah died, I saw the Lord sitting upon a throne, high and lifted up...

*All:* “*Holy, holy, holy is the LORD of hosts; the whole earth is full of his glory!*”

Leader: Come, let us worship and bow down; let us kneel before the LORD, our Maker!

*All:* *For he is our God, and we are the people of his pasture, and the sheep of his hand.*

Leader: Let us worship the Lord.

**\*The Hymn: #262**

*“Holy, Holy, Holy” (vv. 1–3)*

**CALL TO WORSHIP**

We are summoned to worship by God’s word, calling His people into His presence to honor Him in spirit and truth, opening a sacred conversation that unfolds throughout the service. We sing in response to God’s call to worship, which is a reminder that worship is at God’s initiative, not ours.

**HOLY, HOLY, HOLY!**

Reginald Heber’s beloved hymn, first published in 1826, draws us into the heavenly worship of Isaiah 6, where the seraphim proclaim, “Holy, holy, holy is the LORD of hosts; the whole earth is full of his glory.” Yet there is something remarkable about our singing: we are sinful creatures joining the song of heaven. Like Isaiah, who encountered God’s holiness and cried, “Woe is me!”, we come before the Holy One in humility and awe. Yet, by God’s grace, we are welcomed to lift our voices with the angels, proclaiming the glory of our holy and Triune King.

PRAYER OF CONFESSION  
Our worship moves from  
adoration to grace, to  
confession, then assurance,  
and finally to the Table. This  
prayer intentionally  
acknowledges our tendency  
toward self-reliance while  
anticipating the grace that  
Christ offers in the  
Sacrament.

**\*Prayer of Invocation & The Lord’s Prayer**

*Our Father, who art in heaven, hallowed be thy Name. Thy Kingdom come, thy will be done on earth, as it is in heaven. Give us this day our daily bread, and forgive us our debts, as we forgive our debtors. Lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil. For thine is the kingdom, the power, and the glory, forever. Amen.*

**\*The Old Testament Reading:** Leviticus 20:22–26

Leader: “You shall therefore keep all my statutes and all my rules and do them, that the land where I am bringing you to live may not vomit you out. And you shall not walk in the customs of the nation that I am driving out before you, for they did all these things, and therefore I detested them. But I have said to you, ‘You shall inherit their land, and I will give it to you to possess, a land flowing with milk and honey.’ I am the Lord your God, who has separated you from the peoples. You shall therefore separate the clean beast from the unclean, and the unclean bird from the clean. You shall not make yourselves detestable by beast or by bird or by anything with which the ground crawls, which I have set apart for you to hold unclean. You shall be holy to me, for I the Lord am holy and have separated you from the peoples, that you should be mine.” This is the Word of the Lord.

*All: Thanks be to God.*

**\*Congregational Response: #262**

*“Holy, Holy, Holy” (v. 4)*

**The Call to Confession:** 1 John 1:8–9

“If we say we have no sin, we deceive ourselves, and the truth is not in us. If we confess our sins, he is faithful and just to forgive us our sins and to cleanse us from all unrighteousness.”

**Corporate Prayer of Confession**

*Holy and righteous God, you are pure in all your ways and glorious in holiness. In your presence we confess our sin. We have loved what is common and neglected what is holy. We have trusted ourselves more than we have trusted you. Forgive us, O Lord. Cleanse us from our sin, and renew us by your Spirit, that we may walk in your ways and live for your glory; through Jesus Christ our Lord we pray.*

*Silent Confession*

**Assurance of Divine Pardon:** Isaiah 6:6–7

“Then one of the seraphim flew to me, having in his hand a burning coal that he had taken with tongs from the altar. And he touched my mouth and said: ‘Behold, this has touched your lips; your guilt is taken away, and your sin atoned for.’”

**WORD**

**The Giving of Tithes and Offerings**

**The Offertory**

**\*The Doxology and Prayer of Dedication**

*Praise God, from whom all blessings flow; Praise Him, all creatures here below; Praise Him above, ye heavenly host; Praise Father, Son, and Holy Ghost. Amen.*

**\*Children Dismissed to Children’s Church**

CHILDREN’S CHURCH  
Children ages 4 up to 4th  
grade are invited to come  
forward and exit out the side  
door for Children’s Church.  
Following the worship  
service, they may be picked  
up in the Fellowship Hall.

**Scripture Reading**

*Ezra 9:1–4 · Pew Bible, p. 395*

**Scripture Response:** Isaiah 40:6b, 8

Leader: All flesh is grass, and all its beauty is like the flower of the field;  
*All: The grass withers, the flower fades, but the Word of our God will stand forever. Amen.*

**Sermon:** “Restored by Grace: Living as God’s Holy People”

*Rev. Waring Porter*

**Prayer of Commitment**

**Choral Anthem**

*“Table of Grace”  
Pepper Choplin*